

■ B.7.5 External Programs

There are a number of different ways to run external programs from within *Mathematica*. The main difference between them is how input and output from the programs are connected to *Mathematica*. All these mechanisms work only under operating systems such as UNIX which support multitasking and pipes.

<code>Run["command"]</code>	run an external command, with neither standard input nor standard output connected to <i>Mathematica</i>
<code>expr >> "!command"</code>	give the textual form of <i>expr</i> as the standard input to the command
<code><< "!command"</code>	take the standard output of the command as <i>Mathematica</i> input
<code>RunThrough[expr, "command"]</code>	give <i>expr</i> as the standard input to the command, and take the standard output from the command as <i>Mathematica</i> input

Functions for communicating with external programs.